

HELD STILL

"He didn't take them to hurt them. He took them to keep them."

New Series · Psychological Thriller · 3 Seasons · 60 min

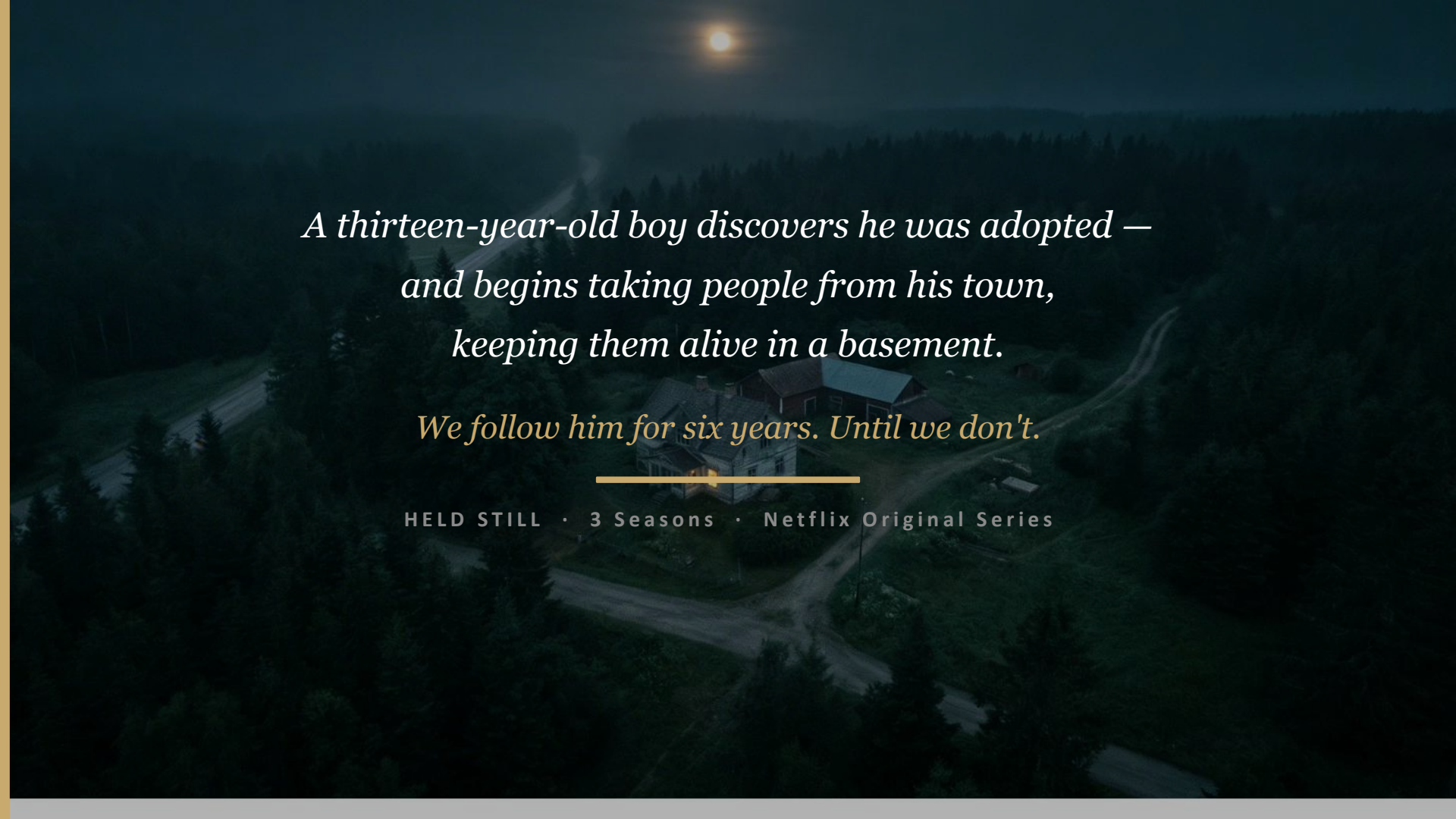


Play



More Info



An aerial night view of a two-story house with a red roof and a smaller addition, situated in a dark, dense forest. A full moon is visible in the dark sky above the house. A dirt road or path winds through the trees around the property.

*A thirteen-year-old boy discovers he was adopted —
and begins taking people from his town,
keeping them alive in a basement.*

We follow him for six years. Until we don't.

HELD STILL • 3 Seasons • Netflix Original Series

THE SHOW

HELD STILL traces the parallel coming-of-age of a young man named ROBI MARSH and the five people he takes from the world — not to harm them, but to keep them. Still. Dependent. His.

The series asks a question with no comfortable answer: what does a person become when the one thing they feared most — abandonment — is the first truth they are ever told about themselves?

Two primary perspectives. The perpetrator. The captives.

THE FORMAT

3

Seasons

8–10

Episodes per season

60 min

Per episode

Age 13 → 19

Robi's arc across the run

Early 2000s

No smartphones. No surveillance.



ROBI MARSH · Born ~1988 · Age 13–19 across three seasons

ORIGIN

Left in a dumpster at birth. Two and a half years in a state institution — systemic abuse, pre-verbal. Adopted by Eleanor and Thomas Marsh, who give him ten years of warmth and stability. On his thirteenth birthday, they tell him the truth. They do not know they have just unlocked something.

PSYCHOLOGY

Robi is not a sadist. He has a profound, pathological terror of being left. His adoptive father Thomas, wheelchair-bound and dependent on Eleanor, planted an image: dependency is the only form of permanence. His victims are not punished. They are preserved. In his mind, what he does is love.

METHOD

Exceptionally intelligent. Reads Eleanor's medical textbooks from childhood — pharmacology, neurology. By thirteen he understands sedative regimes better than most adults. His captives are fully present, aware, and entirely unable to act. This is the show's central horror.

The audience exists. The actor exists. The window is now.

145M

Views, H1 2025

#1 Most-watched show on Netflix globally

#2

All Time

English-language Netflix series — behind
Wednesday only

Emmy + Globe

Outstanding Supporting Actor

Youngest male winner in both awards' histories

Adolescence proved the audience exists. It proved Owen Cooper can carry a global Netflix series.

Held Still is what comes next — longer, deeper, and built for three seasons.

THE WORLD

Rural America • Early 2000s

No smartphones. Slow internet. One sheriff's department. Distance means something here.

40 minutes from town. One farmhouse. One locked door. Five people who haven't stood in years.



THE CAPTIVES

JESSICA COLE

Age 13 · Twin sister of Ashley — the girl Robi loves. Taken first. Her survival and her knowledge of everything that Robi does - is a 6 year long interior project.

DEREK PAULSON

Age 14 · Befriended over weeks as method. An unexpected pragmatic partnership with Jessica.

CLAIRE MORROW

Age 29 · Journalist who investigated the disappearances. Found the farmhouse in S2.

VICTIM FOUR

Local teenager. Camped too close. Robi's most improvised abduction.

VICTIM FIVE

Season 3. A connection to Ryan Cole that accelerates the final convergence.

Five people. Fully conscious. Entirely unable to act.

A young man and woman are sitting on a wooden porch, looking out over a forested landscape at sunset. The woman is on the left, and the man is on the right, leaning against her. The scene is bathed in the warm, golden light of the setting sun, with long shadows and a soft glow on the trees in the background. The man has his arm around the woman's shoulder, and they both have a somber expression.

THE LOVE STORY

ASHLEY COLE

Twin sister of Jessica. The girl Robi loves. The one he will never take.

Every scene between them plays against the audience's knowledge that Jessica is not far away. · In Season 2, Ashley begins to fall — grief, wrong crowd, substances. Robi cannot save her. This is the one system that fails him. · Her death, mid-Season 3, is the cataclysm that ends Robi's certainty and begins his unravelling.



LAW ENFORCEMENT · THE REASON AND THE RECKONING

SHERIFF DALE PRUITT

Mid-50s · Cannot separate his ego from the investigation. Genuinely funny. The reason Robi has six years.

DEPUTY RYAN COLE

Late 20s · Ashley and Jessica's cousin. Building a parallel case with no official sanction. The reason Robi doesn't have twelve years.

"Not incompetence. Vanity. That's all it takes."

PROPOSED LEAD

OWEN COOPER

145M

Adolescence views H1 2025

#2

English-language Netflix
series ever

Emmy
+ Globe

Outstanding Supporting
Actor

Age 16

Right now. Exactly right for
Robi at 13.

Cooper possesses a rare quality of interior life that reads on camera as absolute authenticity. He does not perform emotion — he inhabits it. In *Adolescence* he moved between confusion, terror, manipulation, grief, and something close to sociopathic calculation — sometimes within a single unbroken take — with a naturalism that actors with twenty years of experience cannot manufacture.

Jamie Miller is a boy who may have done something terrible. Robi Marsh is a boy who definitely has — and we will watch him do it, live with it, and become it across ten years and three seasons. That is the role Owen Cooper was born to play next. It is available now, before anyone else gets there first.

"What I saw in Owen was the exact same thing I saw in Jodie Comer when she was 17." — Stephen Graham



HELD STILL

01 THE BOY

Age 13–15

1. Jessica abducted — alibi airtight before she hits the ground
2. Derek: a friendship built as method over weeks
3. Robi's mum begins to notice small things. Robi notices her noticing
4. Police file opened. Robi interviewed as witness. He performs perfectly
5. Finale: Eleanor and Thomas are killed. Robi, alone. A new lock on the door

02 THE STUDENT

Age 16–17

1. Robi at High School — Regular visits to the farmhouse
2. Ashley's decline: wrong crowd, substances, the slow erosion of the girl he loves
3. Claire Morrow, journalist, begins investigating. Robi tracks her for three months
4. Diane arrives — his biological mother. First uncontrollable variable
5. Finale: Claire goes into the farmhouse. Robi comes home. Robi's biological mother arrives, she sits at the diner table. Ashley, attempts suicide, but is unsuccessful (we only find out in the new season)

03 THE UNRAVELLING

Age 18–19

1. Ashley's death, mid-season. The cataclysm that begins Robi's undoing
2. Small mistakes. Then consequential ones
3. Claire, in the basement, finds a way to communicate outward
4. Ryan's case finally intersects with the official investigation at a moment Dale cannot suppress
5. The arrest: quiet, morning, a knock. Final scene: the basement, doors open, light flooding in

She left him in a dumpster.

Fifteen years of guilt and early-internet searching led her here.

She doesn't know what she's found.

He has never been less certain of anything.

Held Still occupies the space between all of them. It is not any of them.

ADOLESCENCE (Netflix, 2025)

145M views · Same audience, same actor, now three seasons

BREAKING BAD

The long transformation. The internal logic. The refusal to look away.

OZARK

Double life. Architecture of the lie. Dark comedy through genuine dread.

SHARP OBJECTS

Rural American Gothic. Trauma. Female survivors. The town that doesn't want to know.

YOU (Netflix)

Perpetrator POV. Audience complicity. A psychology of control.



HELD STILL

A Netflix Original Series

3 Seasons · 8–10 Episodes · 60 Minutes · Rural America · Early 2000s

Proposed Lead

OWEN COOPER

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